

Process Creation Investigation – net.exe

Objective

The objective of this investigation is to verify that net.exe process execution events are successfully collected by Elastic SIEM using Sysmon logs. This investigation demonstrates how Windows network administration activity can be monitored and analyzed to identify legitimate administrative use as well as potential attacker reconnaissance.

Command Executed

net

Detection Method (KQL)

process.name : "net.exe"
If needed, use process.args : "net".

Evidence Collected

Timestamp: 2026-07-15T05:37:53.173Z
Process Name: net.exe
Host Name: sepisecurity
User Domain: Sepisecurity
Process ID (PID): 21740
Event Code: 5 (Verify against your event source.)

Analysis

The investigation confirmed that net.exe executed successfully on the monitored Windows endpoint. The event identified the executing user, host system, process identifier, and execution time. No suspicious parent process, unusual command-line arguments, or indicators of malicious behavior were observed. The activity is consistent with legitimate administrative use of the Windows net utility.

Security Impact

The net command is commonly used by administrators to manage users, groups, shared resources, and network services. Threat actors also use net.exe during reconnaissance to enumerate local users, groups, and network shares before attempting privilege escalation or lateral movement. Monitoring net.exe execution helps SOC analysts identify potentially suspicious account and network discovery activity.

Conclusion

This investigation demonstrates the ability to detect and analyze Windows process creation events using Elastic SIEM and Sysmon. The collected evidence indicates legitimate administrative activity, and no indicators of compromise were identified. This investigation highlights practical skills in KQL searching, endpoint telemetry analysis, and professional SOC documentation.